



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 11

PART 1

You will hear a receptionist and a customer discussing registration for a sailing course. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker A: Welcome to the Crestwood Sailing Club. My name is Sarah, and I'll be helping you today. How can I help you?

Speaker B: Hello there. I'm looking to enroll in the upcoming beginner's sailing course. My name is Thomas Gerrard.

Speaker A: Excellent choice, Thomas. Let me get the registration form open on my system. Could you spell your surname for me, please?

Speaker B: Yes, of course. It's G-E-R-R-A-R-D.

Speaker A: Great, thank you. And can I have a reliable contact number?

Speaker B: My mobile is 0-7-9-1-1-5-5-2-4-8-1.

Speaker A: Let me just write that down and repeat it back to you. That's 0-7-9-1-1-5-5-2-4-8-1. Is that correct?

Speaker B: Yes, that is the correct number.

Speaker A: Perfect. And can I take your date of birth, please?

Speaker B: Yes, it is the fourteenth of August, nineteen ninety-five.

Speaker A: Lovely. Now, we offer a few different types of memberships. We have corporate, family, and individual memberships. Which one would you prefer?

Speaker B: I'll be going with the individual membership, please.

Speaker A: Excellent. Now, about the start date. We have a new cohort beginning on the twelfth of May. Does that suit you?

Speaker B: Let me think. Oh, actually, let me check my calendar. Ah, I have a major work conference on the twelfth, so I won't be able to make that. Is there a later start date?

Speaker A: Yes, we have another intake starting exactly one week later, on the nineteenth of May.

Speaker B: That works much better for me. Let's register me for the nineteenth of May.

Speaker A: Done. What is your current level of sailing experience?

Speaker B: Well, I have done some kayaking on lakes, but as far as actual sailing goes, I am a complete beginner.

Speaker A: Don't worry at all, this course is designed specifically for beginners. What is your primary objective for taking the course? Some people want to get into competitive racing, while others are focused on sea safety.

Speaker B: For me, it is definitely navigation. I really want to learn how to read charts and map out coastal routes.

Speaker A: That's a very popular choice, and we have excellent modules on navigation. How did you first hear about our club, Thomas? Was it through our social media or a recommendation?

Speaker B: Actually, I was in the local library last week and saw a poster on the community notice board.

Speaker A: Oh, that's wonderful to hear! We still find that paper posters work really well in the local area. Now, we assign a personal locker to all our members for storing their wetsuits and gear. Let me see what we have available. I can assign you locker 215... oh, actually, wait, let me check my updated register here... yes, locker 215 is currently undergoing maintenance for a broken lock. I will assign you locker 219 instead.

Speaker B: That's fine, thank you. 219. And how can I pay? Can I do a bank transfer?

Speaker A: For the initial registration fee, we only accept payment by card.

Speaker B: That's fine, I have my debit card with me.

Speaker A: Perfect. The total fee for the mid-season course is one hundred and forty-five pounds.

Speaker B: Great, here is my card.

Speaker A: Thank you. I'll process that now. It will just take a moment to generate your receipt and membership card.

Speaker B: No rush at all, thank you for your help.

Speaker A: You're very welcome. Here is your card, and your course materials will be sent via email tomorrow. We look forward to seeing you on the water!

This is the end of Part 1.

PART 2

You will hear a community organizer giving a talk about volunteer opportunities at the Oakridge Nature Reserve. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Good evening, everyone. My name is Robert, and I'm the volunteer coordinator here at the Oakridge Nature Reserve. It's wonderful to see so many new faces tonight. I'd like to start by telling you a little bit about the history of the reserve. Many people assume that this beautiful area of woodlands and wetlands has always been here, or perhaps that it was set up primarily to protect rare bird species like our resident kingfishers and herons. While wildlife conservation is certainly a major part of what we do today, the actual site has a very different origin. It was established twenty years ago when a former industrial brickworks was decommissioned. The local community didn't want to see the land sold off for housing, so we campaigned to restore the area and let nature take it back over.

Speaker A: Since then, volunteers have been the absolute lifeblood of our reserve. People often ask me what kind of time commitment is required. They worry that they won't be able to dedicate hours every single week. What I always emphasize is that our volunteering opportunities are incredibly flexible. We don't have rigid, fixed shifts that you must sign up for. Instead, they can be easily adjusted to fit around your work, studies, or other family commitments. We have weekend work parties, but we also have weekday tasks and even evening sessions during the summer.

Speaker A: We always have several ongoing projects, but we have to prioritize our resources. At the moment, our main focus is not on planting new woodland trees or sowing wildflower meadows—those are projects for the autumn. Right now, our urgent priority is water conservation, specifically clearing a highly invasive aquatic weed that is growing rapidly and choking our main lake. Left unchecked, this weed blocks out light and oxygen, which threatens the entire aquatic ecosystem.

Speaker A: For those of you interested in helping with this lake project, there are a few practicalities to keep in mind. Because you'll be working close to or even in the water, safety is our top concern. Before anyone can participate, you will need to attend a specialized safety briefing led by our rangers. We will provide all the necessary protective equipment, including heavy-duty chest waders and life jackets, so please don't feel you need to purchase or bring your own gear. It's also a collaborative effort, as our volunteers always work in pairs to ensure safety on the water's edge.

Speaker A: As a thank you for your hard work, we offer various perks to our regular volunteers. While we cannot offer free meals at our small café due to budget constraints, we have partnered with the regional museum. This means all of our active volunteers



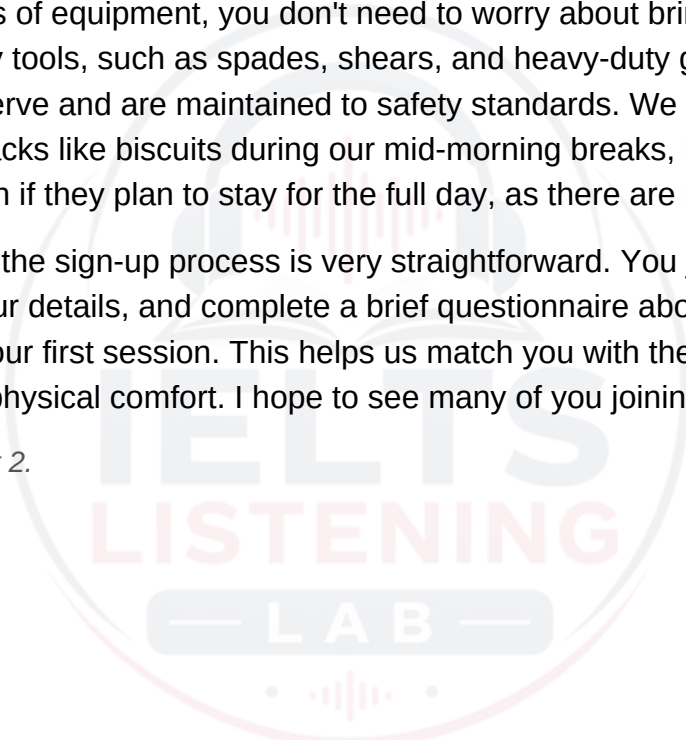
receive complimentary passes to all of their local wildlife and historical exhibitions throughout the year. It's a fantastic benefit that many of our current volunteers highly value.

Speaker A: Now, let's look at some basic guidelines for when you are out working on the reserve. First and foremost is clothing. Even on very warm summer days, we require everyone to wear long trousers. This is because many of our work areas are thick with sharp brambles and stinging nettles, and unprotected legs will quickly end up covered in painful scratches. Additionally, please make sure you wear sunscreen. It is easy to forget this when the sun isn't shining directly, but UV levels remain high even when there is thick cloud, and you can easily get sunburned.

Speaker A: In terms of equipment, you don't need to worry about bringing anything from home. All necessary tools, such as spades, shears, and heavy-duty gardening gloves, are provided by the reserve and are maintained to safety standards. We do provide tea, coffee, and light snacks like biscuits during our mid-morning breaks, but volunteers must bring their own lunch if they plan to stay for the full day, as there are no shops nearby.

Speaker A: Finally, the sign-up process is very straightforward. You just need to visit our website, register your details, and complete a brief questionnaire about your interests and availability before your first session. This helps us match you with the projects that best suit your skills and physical comfort. I hope to see many of you joining us soon.

This is the end of Part 2.



PART 3

You will hear two university students, Helen and Clara, discussing their research project on urban green spaces with their tutor, Professor David Jenkins. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker A: Good morning, Professor Jenkins. Thanks for meeting with us today to discuss our research project.

Speaker C: Good morning, Helen, Clara. It's a pleasure. I've read your initial project proposal on urban green spaces, and I must say it's a very solid start. Why did you choose to focus on this particular topic?

Speaker B: Well, initially, we thought about looking at global deforestation, but then we realized how much of an impact urban heat islands have right here in our own city. We wanted to investigate a local environmental issue that directly affects the people living around us.

Speaker C: That's an excellent rationale. Connecting your academic work to local challenges always makes for a more compelling study. Now, you've already completed your preliminary resident survey. How did that go?

Speaker B: It was really eye-opening. What surprised me most was the sheer variety of activities people engage in when they visit these green spaces. I expected most people to just use them for walking or jogging, but we found many residents using them for social gatherings, creative arts, and even community gardening.

Speaker A: Yes, and we also collected a lot of detailed qualitative feedback in the comments section.

Speaker C: That's excellent. When you begin analyzing this survey data, my advice is to group the respondents by age. This will allow you to see if different demographic groups prioritize different features of urban parks, which could be extremely useful for local planning authorities.

Speaker A: That makes a lot of sense, Professor. We can easily segment the data that way.

Speaker B: We also wanted to ask you about our introduction. We feel it's a bit too broad at the moment.

Speaker C: Yes, I noticed that. To improve it, I suggest you narrow down your core research questions. You've tried to cover too many aspects of urban planning in the first few pages. If you focus specifically on temperature reduction and community well-being, the introduction will be much stronger.

Speaker A: Okay, we will definitely refine that section.

Speaker B: Now, regarding our upcoming presentation next week, we want to make sure it stands out. What do you think is the key to a successful project presentation?

Speaker A: We were thinking of including some complex statistical charts to show our data analysis.

Speaker C: While statistical details are important for the written report, for a presentation, your main goal should be to present a clear and concise summary of your methodology. If the audience doesn't understand how you collected your data, they won't fully trust your conclusions. Keep the slides clean and focus on the overall process.

Speaker B: That's a very good point. We will focus on making the methodology section as clear and visual as possible.

Speaker C: Excellent. Now, let's talk about the specific urban cooling solutions you've researched. You've looked at five different options, correct?

Speaker A: Yes, white-painted roofs, green walls, rain gardens, community orchards, and permeable pavements.

Speaker C: Let's go through them. What did your research show about white-painted or 'cool' roofs?

Speaker B: These are fascinating because of how rapidly they reduce air temperatures in the immediate vicinity. By reflecting solar radiation, they lower building temperatures almost immediately after installation.

Speaker C: Yes, they are highly effective in the short term. What about green walls, where climbing plants cover the facades of buildings?

Speaker A: They look beautiful, but we found that they actually pose a risk of structural damage if the plants aren't managed properly. The root systems can penetrate brickwork and cause dampness.

Speaker C: Indeed, building maintenance teams often worry about that. And rain gardens?

Speaker B: Those are small, planted areas designed to absorb rainwater runoff. The main thing we noted is that they need ongoing community involvement to keep them clear of debris and functioning well. They aren't a 'set-and-forget' solution.

Speaker C: That's true, community stewardship is vital. What did you conclude about community orchards?

Speaker A: They provide great fresh fruit, but they suffer from high initial installation costs. Buying mature fruit trees and preparing the soil is quite a major investment.

Speaker C: Yes, funding is often the primary barrier there. And finally, permeable pavements?

Speaker B: We were impressed by how highly durable they are over the long term. Even though they allow water to drain through them, they can withstand heavy traffic for decades without needing major repairs.

Speaker C: Excellent. You've clearly done some thorough reading on these solutions. I look forward to seeing your completed draft.

This is the end of Part 3.



PART 4

You will hear a university lecture on the history and science of deep-sea hydrothermal vents. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Speaker A: Good morning, everyone. In today's marine biology lecture, we will be exploring one of the most remarkable discoveries of the twentieth century: deep-sea hydrothermal vents. For decades, oceanographers assumed that the deepest parts of the ocean were virtual biological deserts, devoid of life due to the extreme pressure and cold. However, all of this changed in nineteen seventy-seven. It was during an expedition to the Galapagos Rift in the Pacific Ocean that scientists first observed these vents. They did so using a specialized research submersible named Alvin, which was capable of descending thousands of meters.

Speaker A: What they discovered astonished the scientific community. Instead of a barren seafloor, they found a vibrant ecosystem teeming with life, thriving in conditions of absolute darkness. This challenged the fundamental biological assumption that all life on Earth ultimately depends on the sun.

Speaker A: To understand how these ecosystems exist, we must first look at the geological formation of hydrothermal vents. They are typically found along mid-ocean ridges where tectonic plates are pulling apart. Cold seawater, at temperatures near freezing, sinks deep into cracks in the ocean crust. As this water approaches areas of molten magma, it is heated to temperatures exceeding four hundred degrees Celsius. However, because of the immense pressure at these depths, the water does not boil.

Speaker A: This superheated water becomes highly acidic and dissolves minerals from the surrounding volcanic rock, particularly sulfur and metals like copper and iron. Eventually, this mineral-rich fluid is forced back up and exits through the seafloor. As it meets the freezing seawater of the deep ocean, the dissolved minerals rapidly precipitate out of solution, forming towering mineral structures known as chimneys.

Speaker A: Now, let us turn to the unique ecosystem dynamics of these vents. Unlike terrestrial ecosystems, which rely on photosynthesis powered by sunlight, vent communities depend entirely on chemical energy. At the base of this deep-sea food web are specialized microbes. These single-celled organisms perform a process called chemosynthesis, using the toxic chemical hydrogen sulfide emitted by the vents to synthesize organic matter and produce food.

Speaker A: Many of the larger organisms in this environment have developed highly specialized survival strategies. Take, for example, the giant tube worms, which can grow up to two meters in length. These creatures have a unique symbiotic relationship with the

chemosynthetic bacteria. In fact, these tube worms have no mouth or digestive tract whatsoever. Instead, they house billions of bacteria inside an organ called a trophosome, relying entirely on the bacteria to produce nutrients for them.

Speaker A: The discovery of hydrothermal vents has broad scientific significance. For astrobiologists, studying these extreme organisms provides crucial clues about how life first originated on Earth, and offers a model for how life might exist on other icy moons in our solar system, such as Jupiter's moon Europa.

Speaker A: At the same time, there is growing commercial interest in these underwater environments. Many vent zones contain massive seafloor deposits rich in valuable metals, such as gold, silver, and copper. Mining corporations are currently developing technologies to extract these resources, raising serious concerns among environmental scientists about the potential destruction of these fragile and unique ecosystems before we fully understand them. In our next lecture, we will discuss...

This is the end of Part 4.

